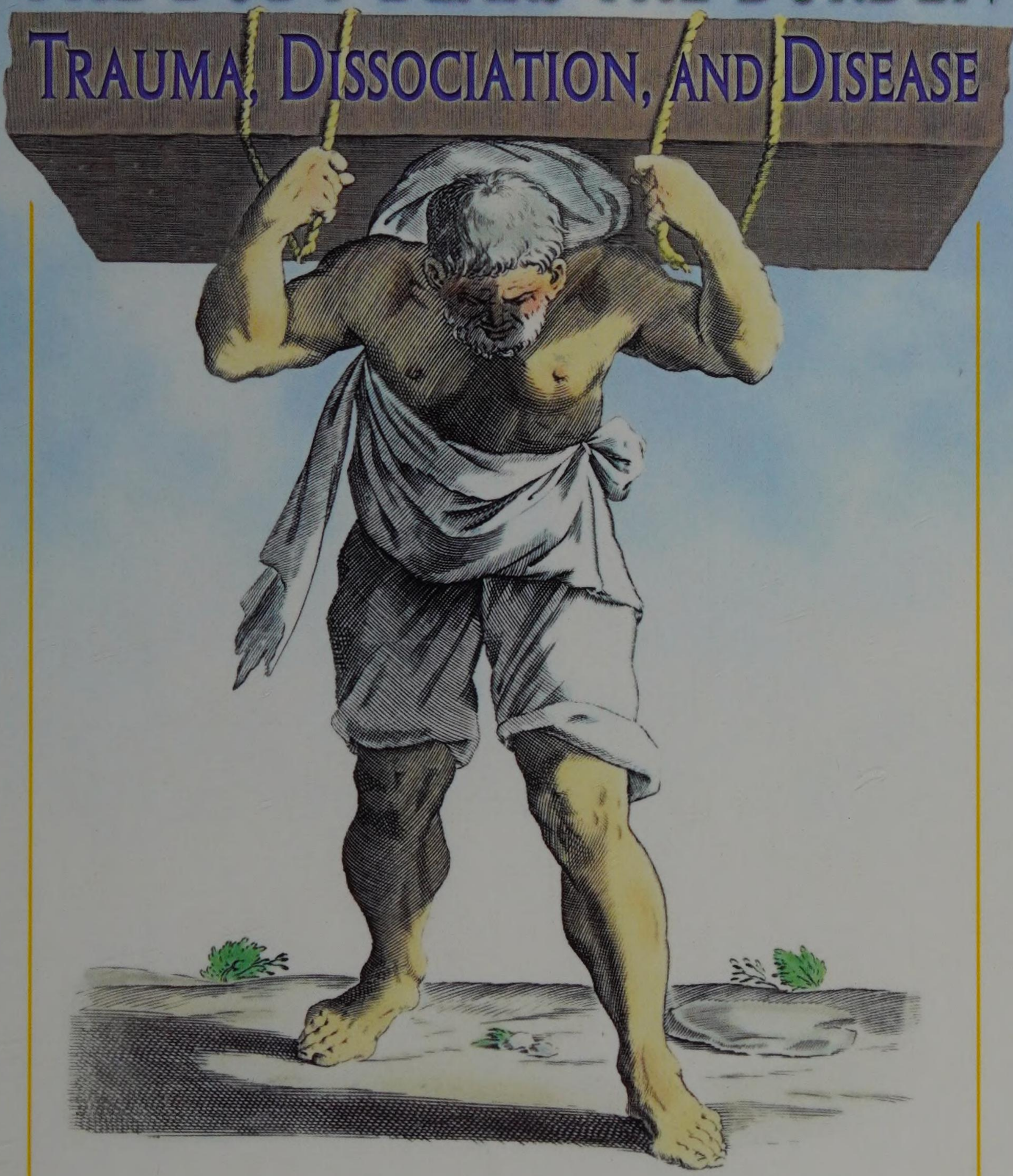
The Body Bears the Burden

Trauma, Dissociation, and Disease



Robert C. Scaer, MD

Using the clinical model of the whiplash syndrome, this groundbreaking book describes the alterations in brain chemistry and function induced in individuals by what is known as traumatic stress or traumatization–experiencing a life-threatening event while in a state of helplessness.

The Body Bears the Burden: Trauma, Dissociation, and Disease presents evidence of the resulting and relatively permanent alteration in neurophysiology, neurochemistry, and neuronal organization–changes correlated with many of the most common, yet poorly understood, physical complaints and diseases, including whiplash, migraines, fibromyalgia, irritable bowel syndrome, and other painful, difficult-to-treat conditions.

ANOTHER GLOWING REVIEW!

"Every year millions of people suffer bewildering and often persistent symptoms in the aftermath of even minor automobile accidents. In developing the concept of 'somatic dissociation,' DR. SCAER ILLUMINATES, WITH FRESH INSIGHT, THESE ELUSIVE AND OFTEN COMPLEX PHYSICAL AND PSYCHOLOGICAL SYNDROMES."

–Peter Levine, PhD, Author,
Waking the Tiger, Healing Trauma

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Pre-publication REVIEWS, COMMENTARIES, EVALUATIONS . . .

"Therapists of various clinical disciplines are now becoming increasingly aware that traumatic disorders involve severe dysregulations of both mind and body. This means that advances in treatment must be based on very recent models that integrate the psychological and biological realms. In light of the current explosion of recent interdisciplinary findings across an array of scientific disciplines, this is a formidable task. Dr. Robert Scaer is in an extraordinary position to address this problem. In addition to possessing more clinical experience in treating traumatic disorders than any other currently practicing neurologist, he is also deeply steeped in a number of scientific literatures that are now producing knowledge directly relevant to a deeper understanding of the psychobiological manifestations of these disorders.

In this remarkable work, Dr. Scaer provides clinically relevant descriptions of the mind/body dysfunctions of both the central and autonomic nervous systems of traumatized patients. In addition, he offers current ideas about the critical role of early affect regulation and child abuse in the pathogenesis of traumatic disorders. Even more than a comprehensive overview, the author presents an integrated psychoneurobiological model of the underlying mechanisms of trauma pathology, which he demonstrates in numerous case histories and applies to various trauma therapies. This is a creative, cutting-edge work, the product of Dr. Scaer's rigorous scientific perspective and extraordinarily intuitive clinical skills. It is valuable as both a guidebook to the individual clinician, as well as a theoretical mapping on which to build more effective treatment models of the traumatic disorders of brain/mind/body."

Allan N. Schore, PhD
Assistant Clinical Professor,
Department of Psychiatry,
University of California
at Los Angeles
School of Medicine



More pre-publication
REVIEWS, COMMENTARIES, EVALUATIONS . . .

"The idea that many diseases of unknown cause are actually due to trauma is not new. But is is surprising to learn that trauma can be the cause of so many familiar physical disorders. Dr. Scaer begins with the whiplash syndrome and extends his convincing analysis to chronic pain syndromes, phantom pain, irritable bowel syndrome, cystitis, fibromyalgia, chronic fatigue syndrome, reflex sympathetic dystrophy, and even autoimmune diseases. The most surprising and novel idea is his finding that an instinctual freeze reaction to a traumatic experience persists as an influence on the body long after the event. The traumatic shock captures and holds portions of the autonomic nervous system in a tonic grip that affects blood flow, hormonal secretion, and neurotransmitter balances of the brain. Until a person gets over the trauma the physical and mental symptoms do not go away.

Dr. Scaer's view of dissociation as an instinctual and physiological response rather than simply a psychological defense opens the door to many new possibilities of treatment for many baffling conditions."

Louis W. Tinnin, MD
Medical Director,
The Trauma Recovery Institute,
Morgantown, West Virginia

"Every year millions of people suffer bewildering and often persistent symptoms in the aftermath of even minor automobile accidents. In developing the concept of 'somatic dissociation,' Dr. Scaer illuminates, with fresh insight, these elusive and often complex physical and psychological syndromes. This landmark book helps both clinicians and theoreticians understand and treat these frustrating symptoms, the bane of many medical and psychological practices."

Peter Levine, PhD
Author,
Waking the Tiger: Healing Trauma

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Psychotherapy, Mental Health & Psychology; Social Work & Human Services

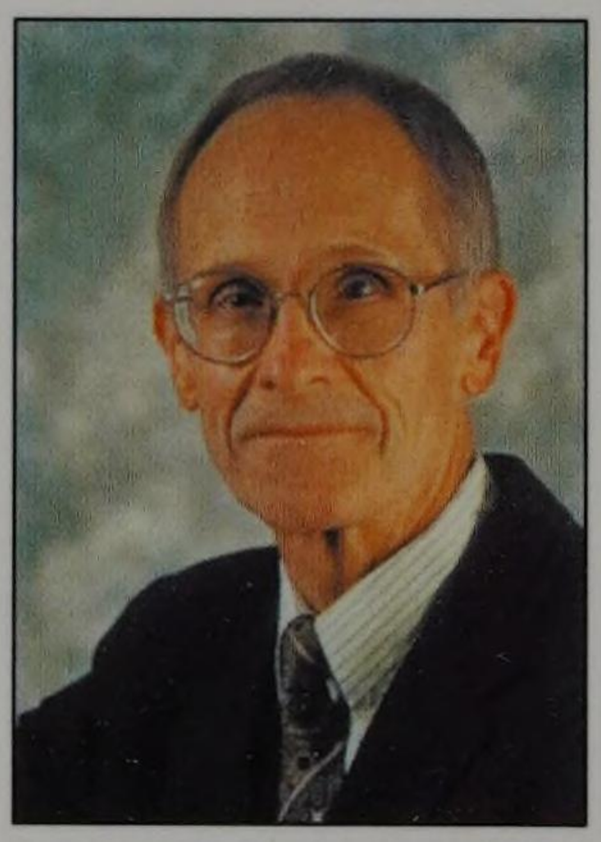
"WHY DOES MY NECK STILL ACHE SO MUCH? THE ACCIDENT WAS MONTHS AGO. MY DOCTOR THINKS I'M CRAZY OR LAZY OR FAKING IT. WHAT'S WRONG WITH ME?"

"EVER SINCE MY DAUGHTER WAS KILLED, I CAN'T CONCENTRATE. I FEEL LIKE I HAVE BRAIN DAMAGE. WHAT'S WRONG WITH ME?"

What's wrong is that physical traumas and emotional traumas are powerfully interrelated. This book identifies the ways that the helplessness and terror of sudden trauma induce changes in brain function and the resulting consequences these changes can have on muscles, digestion, blood pressure, and many other bodily systems. **The Body Bears the Burden** offers new hope to anyone suffering from whiplash, post-traumatic stress disorder, or a history of abuse. It even provides ways to cope with new traumas to minimize the emotional and physical damage!

"REMARKABLE . . . provides clinically relevant descriptions of the mind/body dysfunctions of both the central and autonomic nervous systems of traumatized patients. Even more than a comprehensive overview, the author presents an integrated neuropsychobiological model of the underlying mechanisms of trauma pathology, which he demonstrates in numerous case histories and applies to various trauma therapies. A CREATIVE, CUTTING-EDGE WORK."

–Allan N. Schore, PhD, Assistant Professor, Department of Psychiatry, University of California at Los Angeles School of Medicine



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